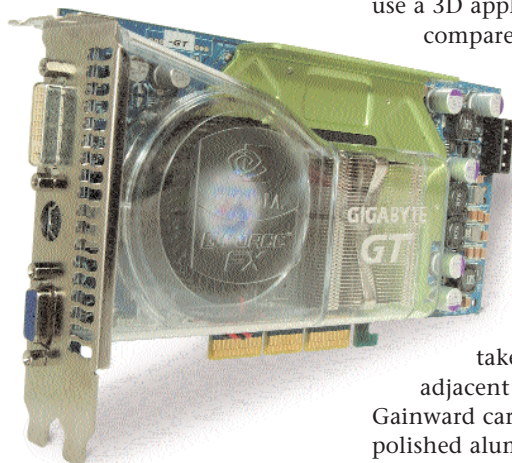


Gigabyte FX5950 Ultra GT Edition and Gainward Ultra 1100 XT

We tested two cards based on nVidia's latest chipset. The Gigabyte FX5950, as the name suggests, is based around the NV38 core, and is a top-of-



Gigabyte FX5950

the-line model that a gamer could die for. On the other hand, Gainward's Ultra 1100XT model of graphics card is based on nVidia's FX5900 XT chipset, which in turn, is a souped-up version of the NV 35 core.

The massive heat sink on the Gigabyte card forms the bulk of its design, and it

looks cool in its metallic green colour over the blue PCB background. The cooling fan runs at two speeds—it's slow in the 2D mode, but speeds up as you use a 3D application. As compared to the FX-5800 cooling system, the cooling system here is barely audible. However, the massive heat sink

takes away adjacent PCI slots. The Gainward card has a polished aluminium heat sink with a two-step regulated fan in the middle.

The Gigabyte package was much better than Gainward—a welcome move considering the price. You also get a Video-In/Video-Out connector module with the Gigabyte, while Gainward makes do with just a cable.

The Gigabyte card falls a tad short of winning the crown from our

performance winner, Gainward's FX-5950Ultra card (refer to the graphics card shootout, 'In Graphic Detail', in February 2004).

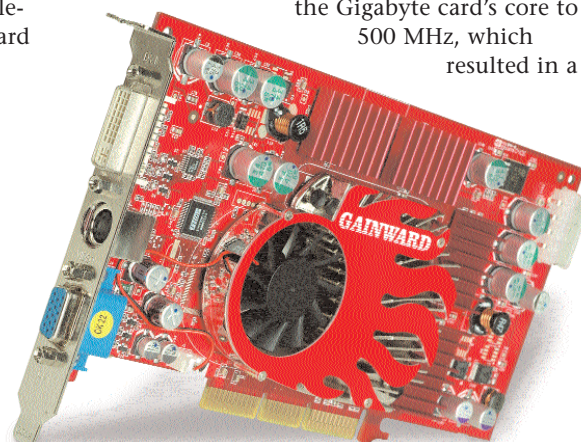
The Gainward FX-5950 belts the Gigabyte card in most of our benchmarks. The Gigabyte card hardly managed to reach within a hand's distance of Gainward's performance.

On the other hand, the FX-5900XT card from Gainward is a middle-tier card

quality does take a toll on any card, and these two cards were no different, but even then the frame rates were above playable rate.

Overclocking utilities come with both cards, and they allowed for an incremental increase in frequency. We overclocked the Gigabyte card's core to 500 MHz, which

resulted in a



Gainward Ultra 1100 XT

that tries to offer the best of both worlds. Although the core and memory are underclocked compared to the FX-5950 cards, the Gainward does offer good performance.

We played games right from the good ol' *Quake III*, *Serious Sam 2*, to the more recent *Call Of Duty*, *Deus Ex: Invisible War* and *UT2K4*, at all possible resolutions up to 1,600x1,200. The game play was great—no jerks, no jagged edges—just pure fun. Even at

1,600x1,200, all games ran smoothly. Turning on effects to enhance the

12 per cent boost in its score, and it was quite stable when we did this.

Priced at Rs 15,875, the Gainward 1100XT offers the highest bang for your buck, offering good performance at a terrific price. Gigabyte's offering burns a hole as large as Rs 36,000 in your pocket, but makes up by offering terrific performance, superb overclocking capabilities and good availability across the country.

PC Mark 2004 (graphics)

Gainward FX 5950 Ultra	4998
Gigabyte FX 5950 Ultra	4960
Gainward Ultra 1100XT	4821

Specs at a Glance

	Gainward 1100XT	Gigabyte FX-5950 Ultra
Core speed	450	475
Memory clock	780	950
Onboard memory	256 MB DDR	128 MB DDR
Outputs offered	D-Sub, DVI and VIVO	D-Sub, DVI and VIVO
Bundled Package	WinDVD, Arx Fatalis	Tomb raider AOD, Rainbow Six Raven Shield, Arx Fatalis, PowerDVD

Gigabyte FX5950 Ultra GT Edition

B-

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 15,875
Company: Mediatech India
Phone: 022-56396696
Fax: 022-22014083
E-mail: sales@mediatechindia.com
Web site: www.gainward.com

Gainward Ultra 1100 XT

B+

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

3D Mark 2003 (1024 x 768 @ 75 Hz)

Gainward FX-5950 Ultra	6510
Gigabyte FX-5950 Ultra	6478
Gainward Ultra 1100XT	5587

Price: Rs 36,000
Company: Digi Giga Systems Ltd
Phone: 022-26526696
E-mail: sales@digigiga.co.in
Web site: www.gigabyte.com.tw